

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

The patient's symptoms suggest a diagnosis of Major Depressive Disorder (MDD) with suicidal ideations. The patient's feelings of hopelessness, difficulty making decisions, and worsening suicidal ideations are common symptoms of depression. The patient's belief that something terrible will happen to him if he thinks about it suggests a pattern of negative thinking that is typical of depression. The patient's ability to hold a job and get enough sleep suggests that the symptoms are not severe enough to interfere with daily functioning, but the presence of suicidal ideations indicates a need for immediate attention. The patient's feelings of guilt from past problems may be related to shame or self-blame, which is also a common symptom of depression. The patient's energy and concentration issues may be related to the depression, as fatigue and difficulty concentrating are common symptoms of depression. The patient's age and the presence of suicidal ideations suggest that the patient may be at risk for double depression, which is a pattern of depression that occurs in middle age or older adults and is characterized by recurrent episodes of depression. </think><answer> A. The patient is at risk for double depression. </answer>

